

SETI PC Report to IAA Commission 1 - March 2023.

The SETI PC executive comprises the chair Prof. Michael Garrett (Univ. of Manchester) with co-chairs Profs. Carol Oliver and Andrew Seimion. Lori Walton is the secretary. The last PC meeting was held in Paris (IAC 2023) and this included remote participation of the members via zoom. The chair's notes for this meeting are available at: [removed]

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The main activity over the last year has been to re-start the PC's work on updating the SETI Post-detection protocols. Carol Oliver & Kathryn Denning are spearheading this effort with support from the rest of the executive - in addition, Les Tennen (IAA BoT & long-standing SETI PC member) is also involved. The protocols were last updated in 2010 and it has been recognised for some time that a review has been long overdue. Since 2010, the nature of global communication among public audiences has been dramatically changed by social media. Kathryn Denning gave a comprehensive review of international activities in this area at the last PC meeting in Paris. This and other presentations made in Paris are available via the link posted above. A paper on the current update activities has been submitted by Oliver, Denning et al. to the IAC 2023.

Another important activity has been the resolution of some confusion over PC membership details - Lori Walton and Fabrice Dennemont (IAA Office) have worked hard to resolve almost all of these issues. Several prominent members of the PC passed away this year, including Frank Drake and other prominent SETI researchers - Franklin Antonio and Bart Wlodarczyk-Sroka.

SETI research is undergoing a transformation globally - there is a rapid expansion of the field, partly driven by an organic renewal of interest in the subject but also due to the efforts of the Breakthrough Listen Initiative (<https://breakthroughinitiatives.org/initiative/1>). The establishment of new and novel SETI research programmes is taking place across the planet, in particular IT, SE, India, Africa, Australia, China & UK. Major SETI related meetings were held at Penn State University (PSETI 2022) and Santa Cruz (Breakthrough Discuss). Suffice to say that there is strong pressure to expand the PC membership. The Executive is looking forward to receiving a new Terms of Reference (ToR) for permanent committees that regulates (amongst other matters) how new members are appointed - it is expected that this new ToR will be finalised by the IAA Board of Trustees soon.

Recently there has been a lot of public and press attention given to UAPs (Unidentified Aerial Phenomena) - at the last PC meeting in Paris, the membership agreed that the PC's focus remains on the search for techno-

signatures beyond the Earth's atmosphere. We feel that this demarkation is consistent with the PC being part of the IAA and its focus on international cooperation in advancing space research and technology. Studies on UAP is encouraged by others and is already addressed by rigorous initiatives such as the Galileo Project <https://projects.iq.harvard.edu/galileo/home>

Various SETI Sessions are scheduled for the IAC 2023 in Baku (2—6 October): SETI Science and Technology (A4.1), SETI & Society (A4.2) plus possible interactive presentations. The SETI sessions are scheduled for 3 October in the morning and afternoon. 38 abstracts have been received for both sessions combined - a healthy response to the Call. The session chairs are Steve Croft and Kathryn Denning - see <https://iafastro.directory/iac/browse/IAC-23/A4/>

The next PC meeting will be scheduled during the IAC in Baku - details to follow. We aim to facilitate remote participation via zoom.

Mike Garrett, SETI PC chair.